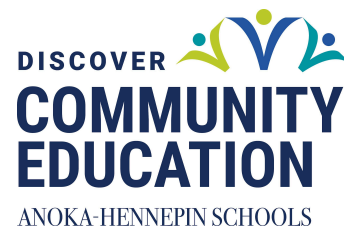


ANOKA HENNEPIN MIDDLE SCHOOLS

Flag Football- Rules 2026

Modified 9/3/26



Number of players on the field is determined by the size of the smallest team in the game. If the smaller team has at least 8 players, we play 7 on 7. If the smaller team only has “x” players, we will play (x-1) on (x-1), or (x-2) on (x-2), etc.

All players on the field must wear a flag belt. No clothing can cover over the belts. No stiff arm or hand slaps to protect your flag belt.

Mouthguards are suggested, but not required.

Games are 45 minutes total time. 20 minute halves. 5 minute halftime. Including any warm up time.

Field size: (Stays the same for all games no matter how many players on the field, 7, 8 or 9)
45 yards long. 10-yard-deep end zone. 23 yards wide. (We will mark 2 yards past the first hash mark in the middle of the field, leaving roughly 20 feet of sideline space in the middle. Distance markers will line this side of the field.)

Offense moving the ball: We start on the 40-yard line. You have 4 downs to get a first down at the 20 yard line. Then you have 4 downs to score.

1 defender must declare they are the rusher and start 7 yards back from the line of scrimmage. Quarterback cannot run until the rusher crosses the line of scrimmage, no clock on the pass if there is no rush.

Scoring: Touchdowns are 6 pts. 2-yard extra point is 1 pt. 5-yard extra point is 2 pts.

Offense: Starts every possession on the 40-yard line. Behind the line of scrimmage, the ball can be passed multiple times. Only one pass over the line of scrimmage. Ball hits the ground and it is dead. Player hits the ground with possession of the ball; they are down, no flag needs to be pulled. The QB must stand behind the line of scrimmage on the snap of the ball. Ball can be snapped between legs or sideways to the QB. Running plays the QB must hand off the ball. The ball must be thrown if it is placed at or within 5 yards of the endzone, if placed outside of the 5 yard line the ball can be run or thrown.

Offensive penalties: Offside/false start- 5 yards. Stiff arm/hand check by the offense on a defensive player- 10 yards from the spot of the foul. Illegal pick or illegal block- 5 yards from the start of the play. Holding- 5 yards from the start of the play.

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Tie games and over time: Each team has one chance to score from the 5-yard line in overtime. If only one team scores they are the winner. If both teams score or neither team scores we will have a tie game.

Defense: Person to person defense. No zone. A defensive player standing in the middle of the field because they are lost or do not know what to do is not a zone. It's a player learning the game. A zone is multiple players playing an area of the field and not an individual opponent. A defensive player must stop with or drop the flag belt as soon as it comes off the offensive player.

Defense intercepts the ball and the ball is dead, change of possession. Start at the 40.

Defensive Penalties: Encroachment defense 5 yards. Defensive holding 10 yards from the start of the play. Tackling a player 10 yards from the start of play.

Unsportsmanlike conduct: Taunting other players- 15 yards added or taken off of the end of the play. Players can also be made to sit for 10 minutes of game time if excessive. Fighting is expulsion from the game and a 15 yard penalty.

Remember coaches. You are assisting officials during the game and we want both coaches to work together. Warning can be given to players instead of penalties. We can use this as a learning situation. If improper behavior persists, penalties need to be given out and game time can be taken away.

*** **VIEW detailed SCHEDULES and STANDINGS for your school at: www.ahmiddleschoolathletics.org**

